basic education
Department:
Basic Education
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE

GRADE 11

TASK 8: LITERATURE ASSIGNMENT

TOTAL /35

TIME ALLOCATED: 2 WEEKS

DATE OF SUBMISSION:

OPTIONAL EXTRA CHOICE 2

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read **ALL** the instructions and adhere carefully to them.

2. This assignment consists of THREE options:
   SECTION A: Poetry (35 marks)
   SECTION B: Novel (35 marks)
   SECTION C: Drama (35 marks)

3. Choose ONE section to answer.

4. Remember to plan, draft, edit, and proofread your response before submitting it. Clearly indicate your planning and cross it out before submitting your final assignment.

5. Your response will be assessed according to the rubric accompanying this task.

6. This is an open-book task. You may have your literature text and/or workbook with you as you complete the task.

7. You will be allocated time in class during PHASE 1 of the task to do your research. PHASE 1 will take place during the first week allocated to the task. PHASE 2 (the second week) will be used for the completion of the task.

8. Number your answer according to the numbering system used on this task sheet.

9. Pay special attention to spelling, language usage, sentence structure and paragraphing.

10. **LENGTH OF RESPONSE:** Your essay should be approximately 350-400 words.

11. Write neatly and legibly.

12. Carry out your research in the following way:
    - Select sources and evaluate their reliability and validity.
    - Compile notes from each source you consult.
    - Highlight the most relevant information for the topic given.
    - Avoid plagiarism and over-reliance on the style of each source by rephrasing the information from the source into your own words as far as possible.
    - Adapt the research notes to the demands of the topic given and integrate the research notes into your discussion of the topic.

13. Consult the following resources to find information for your assignment:
    - Libraries and relevant online websites
    - Dictionaries and thesauri
    - Newspapers, magazines, blogs and journals
    - Television programmes and streaming services (e.g. documentaries, news and current affairs programmes, podcasts and vlogs)
    - Subject experts and professionals (writers, poets, academics)

14. At least THREE sources must be used and cited in a Bibliography according to the following formats:

    Hardcopy sources:
    Author, *Title,* Year of Publication, Publisher, Place of Publication

    For example:
    Fugard, A. *Tsotsi,* 2009, Canongate, Edinburgh.

    Electronic Sources:
    Author of article, *Title of Article*, Year of publication, Website address, Date when website was accessed for research.

    For example:
    Hamad, H.S. *The Use of the Supernatural Power in Shakepeare's Macbeth,* 2021, https://openurl.ebsco.com/, 26 August 2024.

15. Your response will be checked for plagiarism from AI sites such as ChatGPT. While AI sites may be consulted by you for research purposes, information obtained from AI sites needs to be verified by you against two other reliable sources, and the information needs to be rephrased in your own words and integrated into your discussion of the topic. Remember that AI-generated

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responses often contain errors and do not address the specific requirements of assignment questions.

SECTION A: POETRY

'As a poet I regard myself as a world messenger.' – Mbuyiseni Oswald Mtshali

Choose any ONE of the poets of your prescribed poems. Research the life and work of the poet. Then write an essay on your chosen poet's role as a 'world messenger'.

Your response should include the following:

(i) The methods you used to research for this assignment. Mention the following aspects:
- The sources you consulted for your research
- How you determined the reliability of the sources you used
- A disclaimer if you used AI sites for research and the sources you used to check the reliability, and the accuracy of the content generated by the AI sites consulted.
- Challenges faced during the research process and how you overcame them
- A valuable tip you would like to share about the process of research.

(ii) How events in the life of your chosen poet have influenced his/her poetry

(iii) The relevance of the message (theme) that the prescribed poem has for our context.

(iv) The poetic techniques that the poet uses to highlight the theme of the poem under discussion.

(v) A bibliography containing all sources consulted for your research

Your response should take the form of a well-constructed essay of about 350-400 words (about TWO pages).

[35]

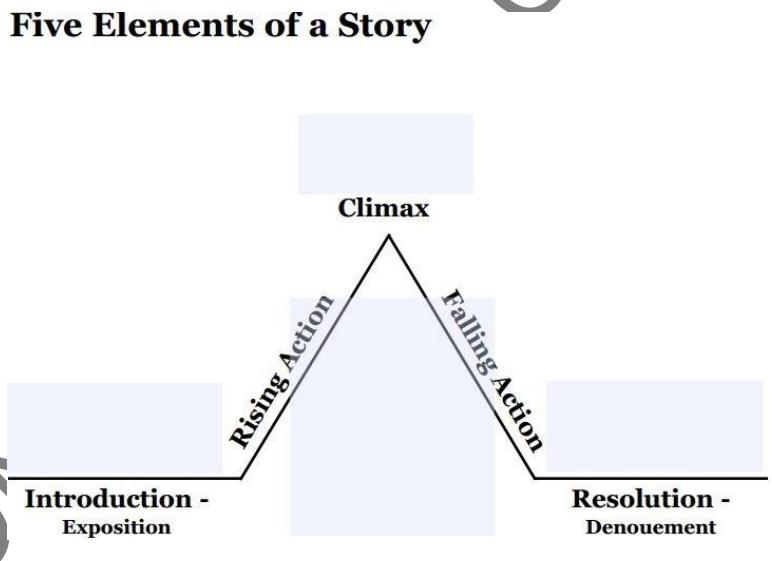
OR

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SECTION B: NOVEL
***TSOTSI* – Athol Fugard OR *THINGS FALL APART* – Chinua Acebe**

In his book, *Technique of the Drama,* nineteenth-century playwright and novelist Gustav Freytag envisioned the rising and falling action of a plot for a drama. The five stages in Freytag's Pyramid are exposition, rising action, climax, conclusion, and denouement. Screenwriters, novelists, and dramatists today still use Freytag's Pyramid as a blueprint for crafting a compelling and emotionally satisfying story.

[Source: https://www.masterclass.com/articles/freytags-pyramid]



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Writers use the literary tool of characterisation to bring characters to life. There are two types of characterisation: direct characterisation and indirect characterisation. In direct characterisation descriptions of their physical appearance, line of work, passions and pursuits are explicitly stated in the text. Indirect characterisation involves an implied description of the character through the character's thoughts, actions, speech, and dialogue with other characters in the novel. Indirect characterisation allows the reader to make

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their own conclusions about a character's essence. Both types of characterisation are necessary and help us to understand the character's make-up better, and how their personality, actions, and perspectives help drive the plot forward.

[Source: https://www.masterclass.com/]

Critically discuss how the characterisation of the main character in the novel you are studying (i.e. EITHER *Tsotsi* OR *Things Fall Apart*) helps to advance the plot of the novel.

Your response should include the following:

(i) The methods you used to research for this assignment. Mention the following aspects:
- The sources you consulted for your research
- How you determined the reliability of the sources you used
- A disclaimer if you used AI sites for research and the sources you used to check the reliability, and the accuracy of the content generated by the AI sites consulted.
- Challenges faced during the research process and how you overcame them
- A valuable tip you would like to share about the process of research.

(ii) The author's preferred method of characterisation. Is the predominant characterisation direct, indirect, or a combination of both types of characterisation. Provide textual evidence illustrating the type of characterisation used for the main character.

(iii) How the characterisation adds to the plot development by driving the plot forward.

(iv) A bibliography containing all sources consulted for your research.

Your response should take the form of a well-constructed essay of about 350-400 words (about TWO pages).

[35]

OR

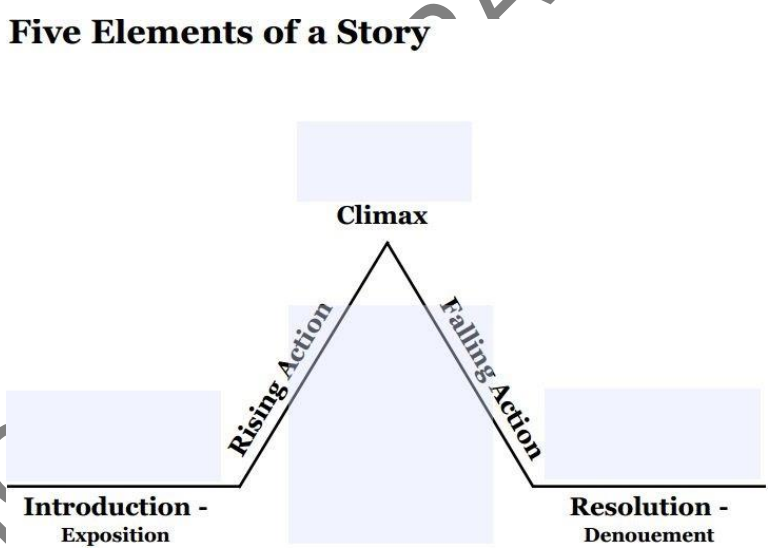
OPTIONAL EXTRA CHOICE 2

SECTION C: DRAMA

***MACBETH* – William Shakespeare OR *THE MERCHANT OF VENICE* – William Shakespeare**

In his book, *Technique of the Drama,* nineteenth-century playwright and novelist Gustav Freytag envisioned the rising and falling action of a plot for a drama. The five stages in Freytag's Pyramid are exposition, rising action, climax, conclusion, and denouement. Screenwriters, novelists, and dramatists today still use Freytag's Pyramid as a blueprint for crafting a compelling and emotionally satisfying story.

[Source: https://www.masterclass.com/articles/freytags-pyramid]



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A theme is a universal idea, lesson, or message explored throughout a work of literature. One key characteristic of literary themes is their universality, which is to say that themes are ideas that not only apply to the specific characters and events of a book or play, but also express broader truths about human experience that readers can apply to their own lives.

[Source: https://www.litcharts.com/]

***MACBETH* – William Shakespeare**

Self-interest and unchecked ambition, as portrayed in William Shakespeare's play *Macbeth*, can destroy even the strongest of relationships and lead to tragic consequences. Critically discuss how this theme is presented through the plot development of *Macbeth.*

OR

***THE MERCHANT OF VENICE* – William Shakespeare**

The Merchant of Venice shows how true love and selflessness can triumph over mercenary motives and societal expectations, leading to personal growth and redemption. Critically discuss how this theme is presented through the plot development of Shakespeare's *The Merchant of Venice.*

Your response should include the following:

(i) The methods you used to research for this assignment. Mention the following aspects:
- The sources you consulted for your research
- How you determined the reliability of the sources you used
- A disclaimer if you used AI sites for research and the sources you used to check the reliability, and the accuracy of the content generated by the AI sites consulted.
- Challenges faced during the research process and how you overcame them
- A valuable tip you would like to share about the process of research.

(ii) The presentation of the theme in each stage of the plot development of the drama. Provide textual evidence of the theme in each stage of the plot.

(iii) The relevance of the theme for today's society.

(iv) A bibliography containing all sources consulted for your research.

Your response should take the form of a well-constructed essay of 350-400 words (about TWO pages)

[35]

TOTAL MARKS: 35

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PHASE 1: WEEK 1

PLANNING

RESEARCH NOTES

For each source consulted, compile research notes using the following template:

SOURCE	
RELIABILITY OF THE SOURCE	
WEBSITES TO CHECK VALIDITY AND ACCURACY OF AI SOURCES	
SUMMARY OF CONTENT	
POINTS RELEVANT TO TOPIC	

ONAL EXTRA CHOICE 2

ESSAY PLANNING TEMPLATE

TOPIC	
INTRODUCTION	
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	
SOURCES CONSULTED	
RELIABILITY OF SOURCES	
AI DISCLAIMER AND WEBSITES	
CHALLENGES	
TIP	
POINT	
EXPLANATION	
EVIDENCE	

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LINK	
POINT	
EXPLANATION	
EVIDENCE	
LINK	
POINT	
EXPLANATION	
EVIDENCE	
LINK	
CONCLUSION	

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PHASE 2: WEEK 2

(1) Use your planning template to write DRAFT 1 of your essay. You may use your literature text and workbook to guide you when writing your response. Remember to compile your bibliography of the sources consulted during your research.
(2) Edit and proofread DRAFT 1
(3) Produce your edited and proofread version.
(4) Hand in your essay on the submission date.

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